

# Motivational Interviewing Refresher

## Topic 1: Reflective Listening

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MANU SINGH-LOONEY, PHD

[MLOONEY@NEWEDITIONS.NET](mailto:MLOONEY@NEWEDITIONS.NET) 301-233-  
8324

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by



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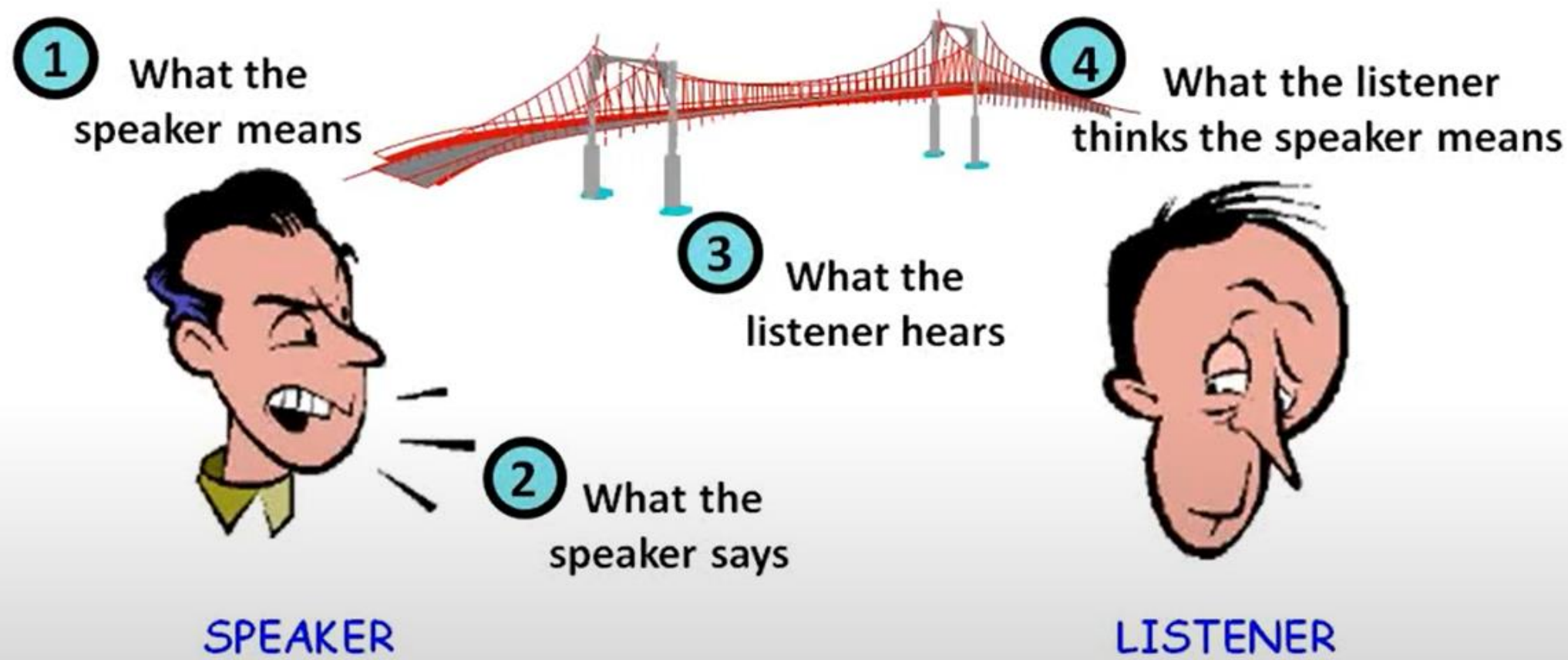
# Utilizing Reflective Listening

Ideally, most of the practitioner's time should be spent listening.



**Reflective listening** – also known as parallel talk or paraphrasing, occurs when the practitioner carefully listens to an individual's thoughts, perceptions, and feelings then restate them for the purpose of clarification and further exploration.

## *Bridge the gap by reflection*





<https://youtu.be/lqRleb7qRvg?si=HnxYEBDPvk9brjYR>

# Utilizing Reflective Listening

- Listening carefully and responding with reflective listening statements encourage and support the individual's ability to explore and problem-solve.
- Reflective listening is a primary way to demonstrate empathy and a genuine willingness to try and understand the person's perspective.
- It's a powerful and underutilized force for change.
- Skilled reflective listening can prompt a person to begin to *talk themselves into change*.
- People are generally more impressed by and tend to believe in what they hear themselves saying compared to what practitioners tell them.
- Open-ended questions and skilled reflections help the individual *hear themselves talking out loud*.

# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

The primary goals are to:



Help the practitioner accurately understand not only what the client is saying, but also what they are meaning by their words.



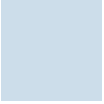
Help the client clarify their thoughts.



Reassure the client that the practitioner is listening and understand their point of view.

# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

Reflective statements helps the practitioner avoid “roadblocks” that prevent clinical progress. Examples of roadblocks:



## Commanding

Imposing a view on the person that they need to act in a certain way



## Threatening

Warning or cautioning the person about what might happen if they do not change



## Prematurely giving advice

Offering unsolicited solutions or making suggestions



## Moralizing

Telling people what they should do



## Criticizing

Disagreement between practitioner and client which implies judgment or blaming



## Shaming

Labeling or ridiculing the client can make them feel humiliated



# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

Here are several phrases you can use to clarify and reflect back your understanding of what the individual is trying to convey:

- ☐ *I understand the problem is...*
- ☐ *I'm sensing...*
- ☐ *I wonder if...*
- ☐ *I get the impression that...*
- ☐ *As I hear it, you...*
- ☐ *From your point of view...*
- ☐ *In your experience...*
- ☐ *I'm picking up that...*
- ☐ *Where you're coming from...*
- ☐ *You mean...*
- ☐ *Could it be that...*
- ☐ *Let me see if I understand. You...*
- ☐ *You feel...*
- ☐ *From where you stand...*
- ☐ *You think...*
- ☐ *What I think I hear you saying...*

# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

The practitioner is not simply restating the individual's thoughts verbatim (although sometimes using their own words can be very powerful).

Rather, strategically restating the individual's words to encourage more thought and discussion.

*Client: "I don't have a drug problem. I just smoke a little weed every night before bed to help with sleep."*

*Practitioner: "You use marijuana every day of the week, and you do not feel that you have a drug problem."*

# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

Reflective listening may include the practitioner's inferences based on previous statements – called “continuing the paragraph”.

Be careful not to overreach and go too far beyond what the individual is trying to convey.

*Client: “I don’t want to be like my parents with mu kids. They never cared for me like they should because they were always drunk or high or gone.”*

*Practitioner: You want a better life for yourself and your kids. So, you are here to ensure that substances do not interfere with that.”*

# Utilizing Reflective Listening (cont.)

- Most of the practitioner's responses in a session should be reflective listening statements.
- Asking a series of questions may be easier and feel more comfortable but Q&A puts the responsibility for fixing the client's problems on the practitioner.
- The task is to help the individual make their own solutions using their own resources and motivation.
- There may be a tendency to think that a heavy dose of reflective statements is not effective in moving the client to the action stage – **This is not the case.**
- Reflection encourages an individual's self-efficacy and intentions to change.



# Types of Reflective Listening

|                     | PURPOSE                                                                                  | SPECIAL CONSIDERATIONS                                                                                     |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Repeat</b>       | Builds rapport. Expresses empathy.                                                       | Avoid mimicking.                                                                                           |
| <b>Rephrase</b>     | Expresses empathy. Highlights selected meaning or feeling.                               | Move the conversation along, but more slowly than complex reflections.                                     |
| <b>Complex</b>      |                                                                                          |                                                                                                            |
| <b>Feeling</b>      | Highlights selected feeling. Highlights discrepancy between values and current behavior. | Selectively reinforce change talk. Avoid reinforcing sustain talk.                                         |
| <b>Meaning</b>      | Highlights selected meaning. Highlights discrepancy between values and current behavior. | Selectively reinforce change talk. Avoid reinforcing sustain talk.                                         |
| <b>Double-sided</b> | Resolves ambivalence. Acknowledges sustain talk <b>and</b> emphasizes change talk.       | Use “and” to join two reflections. Start with sustain talk reflection and end with change talk reflection. |
| <b>Amplified</b>    | Intensifies sustain talk to evoke change talk.                                           | Use sparingly. Avoid getting stuck in sustain talk.                                                        |



| TYPE                | CLIENT STATEMENT                                                                                                                                     | COUNSELOR RESPONSE                                                                                                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Simple</b>       |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Repeat</b>       | "My wife is nagging me about my drinking."                                                                                                           | "Your wife is nagging you about your drinking."                                                                            |
| <b>Rephrase</b>     | "My wife is nagging me about my drinking."                                                                                                           | "Your wife is pressuring you about your drinking."                                                                         |
| <b>Complex</b>      |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Feeling</b>      | "I'd like to quit smoking marijuana so that the secondhand pot smoke won't worsen my daughter's asthma."                                             | "You're afraid that your daughter's asthma will get worse if you continue smoking marijuana."                              |
| <b>Meaning</b>      | "I'd like to quit smoking marijuana because I read that second-hand pot smoke can make asthma worse and I don't want that to happen to my daughter." | "You want to protect your daughter from the possibility that her asthma will get worse if you continue smoking marijuana." |
| <b>Double-sided</b> | "I know I should give up drinking, but I can't imagine life without it."                                                                             | "Giving up drinking would be hard, <b>and</b> you recognize that it's time to stop."                                       |
| <b>Amplified</b>    | "I think my cocaine use is just not a problem for me."                                                                                               | "There are absolutely no negative consequences of using cocaine."                                                          |

# A Little Video Demonstration

## Pulling Your Own Strings (A Reflective Listening Demo)

<https://youtu.be/SZ-IH-V7oJ4?si=og1IPYwC4GzYnBKk>



# Peer Case Consultation

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How's it going doing SBIRT?

What is going well?

Where do you feel stuck and need some assistance?



# Break Out Practice

Practice reflective listening as a dominant style in one-to-one conversation

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1. **Repeating.** The simplest reflection simply repeats an element of what the speaker has said.
  2. **Rephrasing.** Here the listener stays close to what the speaker said, but substitutes synonyms or slightly rephrases what was offered.
  3. **Paraphrasing.** This is a more major restatement, in which the listener infers the *meaning* in what was said and reflects this back in new words. This adds to and extends what was actually said. In artful form, this is like *continuing the paragraph* that the speaker has been developing ? saying the *next* sentence rather than repeating the last one.
  4. **Reflection of feeling.** Often regarded as the deepest form of reflection, this is a paraphrase that emphasizes the emotional dimension through feeling statements, metaphor, etc.

In general, simpler (1 and 2) reflections are used at first, when meaning is less clear, and deeper reflections are ventured as understanding increases.

Jumping too far beyond what was said, however, can turn into interpretation (a roadblock).

# Break Out Practice

Practice reflective listening as a dominant style in one-to-one conversation

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- Break out into pairs, chose who will be speaker first
- **Speaker** talks about something you felt two ways about, something you feel ambivalent about, something you've wanted to change but haven't been able to commit to
- Before beginning, set timer for 7 minutes
- **Listener's** task: respond *only* with reflective-listening statements.
  - Although it would be natural to intermix reflection with other forms (e.g., questions), The speaker responds to reflection by continuing to elaborate.
- Stay in role, not discussing or breaking role until 7 minute timer goes off
- After 7 minutes, switch roles

# BRIEF NEGOTIATED INTERVIEW (BNI) ALGORITHM

|                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1) BUILD RAPPORT                                                                                                                        | Tell me about a typical day in your life. Where does your current [X] use fit in?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 2) PROS & CONS<br><br>Summarize                                                                                                         | Help me understand, through your eyes, the good things about using [X].<br>What are some of the not-so-good things about using [X]?<br><br>So, on the one hand [PROS], and on the other hand [CONS].                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 3) INFORMATION & FEEDBACK<br><br>Elicit<br><br>Provide<br><br><br><br>Elicit                                                            | I have some information on low-risk guidelines for drinking and drug use, would you mind if I shared them with you?<br><br>We know that drinking... <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 4 or more (F) / 5 or more (M) drinks in 2 hrs</li> <li>• or more than 7 (F) / 14 (M) drinks in a week</li> <li>• having a BAC of ____</li> </ul> ...and/or use of illicit drugs such as ____<br><br>...can put you at risk for social or legal problems, as well as illness and injury. It can also cause health problems like [insert medical information].<br><br>What are your thoughts on that?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 4) READINESS RULER<br><br><br>Reinforce positives<br><br>Ask about lower #                                                              | This Readiness Ruler is like the Pain Scale we use in the hospital.<br>On a scale from 1-10, with 1 being not ready at all and 10 being completely ready, how ready are you to change your [X] use?<br><br>You marked ____ . That's great. That means you are ____ % ready to make a change.<br><br>Why did you choose that number and not a lower one like a 1 or a 2?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 5) ACTION PLAN<br><br>Identify strengths & supports<br><br>Write down steps<br><br>Offer appropriate resources<br><br><br>Thank patient | What are some steps/options that will work for you to stay healthy and safe?<br>What will help you to reduce the things you don't like about using [X]?<br><br>What supports do you have for making this change?<br>Tell me about a challenge you overcame in the past. How can you use those supports/resources to help you now?<br><br>Those are great ideas! Is it okay for me to write down your plan, your own prescription for change, to keep with you as a reminder?<br>Will you summarize the steps you'll take to change your [X] use?<br><br>I have some additional resources that people sometimes find helpful; would you like to hear about them? <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Primary Care, Outpatient counseling, Mental Health</li> <li>• Suboxone, Methadone clinic, Needle Exchange, AA/NA, Smoking cessation</li> <li>• Shelter, Insurance, Community Programs</li> <li>• Handouts and information</li> </ul><br>Thank you for talking with me today. |

# Step 1: Engagement

|                        |                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ask permission</b>  | Would you mind taking a few minutes to talk about your [X] use?<br><br>Before we go further, I'd like to learn a little more about you. |
| <b>Day in the life</b> | What is a typical day like for you?                                                                                                     |
| <b>Substance Use</b>   | Where does your [X] use fit in?                                                                                                         |
| <b>Explore Values</b>  | What are the most important things in your life right now?                                                                              |

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|          |                                                                                                                         |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>C</b> | Have you ever ridden in a CAR driven by someone (including yourself) who was “high” or had been using drugs or alcohol? |
| <b>R</b> | Do you ever use alcohol or drugs to RELAX, feel better about yourself, or fit in?                                       |
| <b>A</b> | Do you ever use alcohol or drugs while you are by yourself, ALONE?                                                      |
| <b>F</b> | Do your FAMILY or FRIENDS ever tell you that you should cut down on your drinking or drug use?                          |
| <b>F</b> | Do you ever FORGET things you did while using alcohol or drugs?                                                         |
| <b>T</b> | Have you ever gotten into TROUBLE while using, or because of using alcohol or drugs?                                    |

## Step 2: Pros and Cons

### Explore Pros and Cons

#### Pros

- “good things”
- “things it does for you”
- “things you like about it”

#### Cons

- “not so good things”
- “things you don’t like as much”
- “the downsides, or drawbacks”

I’d like to understand more about your use of [X]. What do you enjoy about it?

What do you enjoy less (or regret) about your use of [X]?

If NO con’s: Explore problems mentioned during the CRAFFT or other information you have.

“You mentioned that... Can you tell me more about that situation?”

### Use Reflective Listening

It sounds like you.....

### Summary

So, on the one hand you said [PROS], and on the other hand [CONS].

## Step 3: Feedback & Information

Ask permission

I have some information on [X] use—  
would you mind if I shared it with you?

Provide information

We know that drinking...  
  
...Or using [X] *[insert drug information here]*  
  
...can put you at risk for social and legal problems, as well as illness and injury. It can also cause health problems like...  
*[insert relevant health issues here]*.

Elicit response

What are your thoughts on that?



## Alcohol



### Get the Facts

- Alcohol use can have lasting **effects on the developing brain**. Adolescent who drink can experience impaired memory and attention, slower reflexes, and reduced cognitive functioning.
- **Most youth don't drink**. Almost 82% of 12- to 20-year-olds haven't had a drink in the last month.
- Alcohol and other substance use during adolescence **increases the risk of negative personal, social, physical, and mental health outcomes** such as problems at school, relationship issues, physical and mental health concerns, sexually transmitted diseases, pregnancy, injury and car accidents, and legal problems. While intoxicated, teens are more likely to engage in unsafe behavior such as drinking and driving, unprotected sex, and aggressive or violent actions.

Sources:

[https://store.samhsa.gov/sites/default/files/SAMHSA\\_Digital\\_Download/PEP21-03-03-001.pdf](https://store.samhsa.gov/sites/default/files/SAMHSA_Digital_Download/PEP21-03-03-001.pdf)

[https://store.samhsa.gov/sites/default/files/SAMHSA\\_Digital\\_Download/PEP21-03-10-007.pdf](https://store.samhsa.gov/sites/default/files/SAMHSA_Digital_Download/PEP21-03-10-007.pdf)

## Marijuana



### Get the Facts

- **Marijuana affects your brain**. Tetrahydrocannabinol (THC), the chemical responsible for most of marijuana's psychological effects, affects brain cells throughout the brain, including cells in circuits related to learning and memory, coordination, and addiction.
- **Marijuana affects your self-control**. Marijuana can seriously affect your sense of time and your coordination, impacting things like driving.
- **Most teens aren't smoking marijuana**. In fact, only 6.5% of youth ages 12 to 17 said that they had smoked marijuana in the past month.
- Marijuana affects your **coordination and reaction time**, raising your risk of injury or death from car crashes and other accidents. Co-use of alcohol or other drugs heightens crash risks.

Source:

<https://store.samhsa.gov/sites/default/files/d7/priv/pep19-05.pdf>

## E-Cigarettes



### Get the Facts

- **E-cigarettes can contain harmful substances that are bad for your health**. The aerosol emitted can contain heavy metals such as lead, volatile organic compounds, and cancer-causing agents. The compounds can also lead to lung diseases such as bronchitis, heart disease, and pneumonia.
- **Over 86% of youth don't vape**—and among the minority who do vape, most are not regular users.
- E-cigarette use **harms the developing brain**. E-cigarettes typically deliver nicotine, a harmful drug to the youth brain and body. Teens are particularly vulnerable to the effects of nicotine since the brain is still developing.
- The nicotine in e-cigarettes and other tobacco products can also prime young brains for **addiction** to other drugs, such as cocaine and methamphetamine.

Sources:

<https://store.samhsa.gov/product/Tips-for-Teens-The-Truth-About-E-Cigarettes/PEP19-12>

<https://doi.org/10.1093/ntr/ntaa010>

## Step 4: Assess Readiness

|                     |                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ruler               | On a scale from 1-10, with one being not ready at all and 10 being completely ready, how ready are you to change your [X] use? |
| Reinforce positives | You marked _____. That's great.<br>That means you're _____% ready to make a change.                                            |
| Envisioning Change  | Why did you choose that number and not a lower number, like a 1 or 2?<br><br>It sounds like you have reasons to change         |

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

## Step 5: Negotiate Action Plan

|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Create down action plan</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Ask client for ideas first</li></ul> | <p>What are some options/steps that will work for you?</p> <p>What are you willing to do for now to be healthy and safe?</p> <p>What will help you to reduce the things you don't like about using [X]?</p> |
| <b>Envision the future</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Probe for goals</li></ul>                | <p>What do you want your life to look like down the road?</p> <p>How does this change fit in with where you see yourself in the future?</p>                                                                 |
| <b>Explore challenges</b>                                                                                   | <p>What are some challenges to reaching your goal?</p>                                                                                                                                                      |

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## Step 5: Negotiate Action Plan (cont.)

### Draw on Past Successes

- Identify strengths & supports

What have you planned/done in the past that you felt proud of?  
Who has helped you succeed?  
How can you use that (person/method) again to help you with the challenges of changing now?

### Explore benefits of change

If you make these changes, how would things be better?

| <b>Step 6: Summarize and Thank</b> |                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reinforce resilience and resources | Those are great ideas! ....include some details                                                                                    |
| Ask permission                     | Is it okay for me to write down your plan, your own prescription for change, to keep with you as a reminder?                       |
| Write down action plan             | Let's summarize what we've been discussing, and you let me know if there's anything you want to add or change (review Action Plan) |

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| <b>Step 6: Summarize and Thank (cont.)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provide handouts                           | Give referrals if appropriate: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Suggest other services that might be useful</li><li>• Make an “active referral”</li></ul> |
| Give action plan & Thank client            | This is an agreement between you and yourself.<br>Thank you for sharing with me today.                                                                           |

Slide courtesy of Boston University: BNI-ART Institute